

## EVERYONE LOVES A SLUMDOG

An INDIA TODAY-Synovate poll of 1,600 respondents across eight cities showed the nation has embraced *Slumdog Millionaire* and its combination of fairy tale and realism

**Q. What do you think of the film *Slumdog Millionaire*?**

**Outstanding 39%**

**Good 49%**

**Average 11%**

**Bad 1%**

Almost a fourth of Mumbai respondents rated it average while 57% in Lucknow felt the film was outstanding

**Q. How did you feel after watching the movie?**

**It was sensitive 50%**

**It did not portray reality 25%**

**I felt angry 18%**

**It had no impact 7%**

38% in Delhi were angry because of the way poverty in India was portrayed while 43% in Mumbai felt it didn't reflect Indian reality

**Q. Who was your favourite character?**

**Young Jamal, Latika and Salim 39%**

**Dev Patel 28%**

**Freida Pinto 13%**

**Anil Kapoor 20%**

**Q. Does it deserve an Oscar for Best Picture?**

**Yes 80%**

**No 13%**

**Don't know 7%**

**Q. Have there been Indian films that deserved an Oscar more than *Slumdog Millionaire*?**

**Yes 81%**

**No 13%**

**Don't know 6%**

The respondents loved its narrative extremes but felt its clichés have been told better by Indian filmmakers in the past

*The survey conducted on men and women between the ages of 18 and 60, used a mix of telephone, face-to-face and the Synovate computer aided-telephonic-interviewing system*



**RESUL POOKUTTY, 36**

“These are not just awards but history being handed over to us.”

The operator at The Intercontinental in Los Angeles doesn't ask you to spell his last name. A BAFTA award for best sound editing shared with Glenn Freemantle, Richard Pryke, Tom Sayers and Ian Tapp; an award from the Cinema Audio Society for outstanding achievement in motion picture sound mixing, and an Oscar nomination, both shared with Pryke and Tapp, have that effect. FTII graduate Pookutty, who is on the way to becoming a legend in Bollywood for 13 years of work that moves from the big-budget *Black* to the experimental *Gandhi My Father*, is known to be exacting about his work. Which is why one day he stormed off the sets of *Slumdog*, unable to cope with Boyle's demands. “Danny was gracious enough to talk me back into the film but the film was very difficult to record. I had to reinvent myself. Often Danny would shoot a long shot and close up at the same time. I had to respond with a combination of microphoning and multitrack recording with 20 microphones at different points,” says Pookutty, who is now looking at hiring an agent in Los Angeles, and is particularly proud of being the first Indian member of the 500-select Cinema Audio Society. History has been made, he says. Now comes the responsibility.